

The 6:15

MONDAY · AUGUST 10, 2026

NO. 1

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Mon 8/10	13-wk & 26-wk T-bill auctions
Wed 8/12	July CPI (BLS, 8:30a); Cisco earnings AMC — cons. EPS \$1.17, rev \$16.83B
Thu 8/13	July PPI (BLS); jobless claims; Applied Materials AMC — cons. EPS \$3.39, rev \$9.01B
Fri 8/14	July retail sales (Census); UMich sentiment, prelim (8:30a/10a)
Sun 8/17	30-yr Treasury bond auction
Tue 9/16	Next FOMC decision — outside window; this week's CPI/PPI are the key inputs

OPEC+ full ministerial / JMMC: next date within this window **not confirmed this run** — last full ministerial was June 7; next JMMC date not verified.

METRICS · ~6:00A ET AUG 10 UNLESS NOTED

Brent (ICE, front)	\$84.39, +\$0.84 / +1.0% — wk: fell >7% last wk
WTI (NYMEX, front)	\$78.77, +\$0.60 / +0.75%
Brent–WTI spread	\$5.62
UST 2Y / 10Y / 30Y	4.25% · 4.22% 30Y as of 8/5 close, stale · 5.17%
DXY	99.67, -0.36%
S&P / Nasdaq-100 fut.	+0.13% / +0.25%; Dow fut. -0.02% (premk)
VIX	14.90, -1.65% Fri cash close
Gold (spot)	\$4,399.70, +2.33%
Nikkei 225 / Hang Seng	66,970.22 +2.1% / 25,904.94 +0.9% (Mon close)
Europe (DAX/FTSE/CAC)	not confirmed this run
Retail gas, natl. avg.	\$4.0121 (AAA, as of 8/9)

Crude, DXY, gold, futures per Reuters/CNBC/TradingEconomics quote pages, ~6:00A ET. UST 10Y per prior-session close (CNBC); 2Y intraday.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure, day count	Day 162 (straits.live tracker, as of 10:23 UTC 8/10)
Transits vs. baseline	2 vessels on 8/2 vs. 73/day pre-crisis (IMF/Oxford PortWatch, AIS snapshot)
Weekly transits	84 total, wk of 7/27–8/2, up from 45 (Lloyd's List Intelligence, >10,000 dwt)
Non-Iranian-linked	52 transits, up from 28; ~25% via untracked Omani "dark" corridor (Lloyd's List)
Strikes, 24h / running	0 confirmed new / 2 ships struck + 1 attempt via Omani route since 8/1 (Lloyd's List, latest confirmed)
War-risk premium	3–10% of hull value vs. 0.25% pre-war; ~\$10.0M to insure one VLCC, ~30x (straits.live)

PortWatch's figure is a single-day AIS snapshot with a multi-day publication lag; Lloyd's List's figure is a weekly analyst rollup of tracked-plus-dark-fleet transits. They measure different windows and vessel sets — never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	No reported roster moves in the last 24 hours
Knicks	No reported roster moves in the last 24 hours
Northwestern	No reported roster moves in the last 24 hours

LEAD

[NEW] OIL · HORMUZ · FED

A fraying Hormuz deal puts a hawkish Fed chair's first real test back on the table.

Crude reversed course overnight. Brent added \$0.84 to \$84.39 and WTI \$0.60 to \$78.77 as of roughly 6:00 a.m. ET Monday — a 1% and 0.75% move, respectively, that claws back a sliver of the more than 7% both benchmarks shed last week. The trigger was Iranian foreign minister Abbas Araghchi's Sunday remarks that, even as Tehran and Oman near a technical agreement on shipping-lane coordinates through the Strait of Hormuz, the waterway will not actually reopen until Washington eases sanctions and pays war

reparations. Iran's Revolutionary Guard reinforced the point Saturday, saying its strategy is to hold the strait until "the enemy accepts all their conditions." Markets had spent last week pricing a deal as close to done; the conditionality is now being repriced back in.

The mechanism matters because the Oman-Iran track was always narrower than headlines suggested — an interim, technical arrangement on inbound/outbound routes and a joint coordination center, not a ceasefire, and explicitly not sufficient on its own to lift the closure. That distinction is now the market's central risk: prediction markets (Polymarket/Kalshi) put the odds of a full reopening by August 15 at under 1%, by August 31 at 4%, and by year-end at 48% — a crisis still expected to run past its fifth-month mark with no fixed resolution date.

The second-order consequence lands on the Fed. Kevin Warsh, Trump's hand-picked and avowedly hawkish successor to Jerome Powell, has been in the chair since May 22 and faces the first real collision between his inflation instincts and the data. July's nonfarm payrolls print showed the economy shed 23,000 jobs against a consensus call for +80,000 — a sharp, one-sided miss that knocked CME FedWatch-implied odds of a 25bp hike at the September 16 FOMC meeting down to roughly 44%, from 67% a week earlier. Hike odds, not cut odds: with Warsh at the helm and oil back above \$84, the market is still assigning real probability to tightening even as the labor market visibly softens — an unusual posture for this point in a cycle, and a direct read on how much credibility investors extend to a chair installed explicitly to run hot on inflation risk. Wednesday's CPI and Thursday's PPI, both for July, will be the next

data points testing that pricing, with crude's renewed strength a live pass-through risk into both prints.

Equities have so far declined to fully engage with the tension. The S&P 500 closed at a record 7,757.64 on Friday, up 3.58% on the week — its best since April — on read-through from the same jobs miss that a soft economy buys the Fed room to ease. Monday's futures are more ambivalent: S&P +0.13%, Nasdaq-100 +0.25%, Dow futures -0.02% in premarket trade, a far more muted response to the oil move than the bond and gold markets are showing. Gold is up 2.33% to \$4,399.70, a safe-haven and inflation-hedge bid that lines up more closely with the Hormuz/Fed risk than the equity tape does. The gap between what stocks are pricing (a Fed that eases through a soft patch) and what oil, gold and hike-probability futures are pricing (a Fed that may still have to fight energy-driven inflation) is the thing to watch into Wednesday's CPI — and the reason this is the story that moved the most overnight, even before the open.

Last week's record run — the S&P's best week since April, alongside a fresh high on Canada's TSX Composite — was led by technology and materials, the same two sectors now sitting on opposite sides of this week's setup: technology carries the AI-capex financing story detailed below in Business and Technology, while materials' leadership tracked gold's rally directly. That pairing is unusual outside of genuine stagflation scares, and it's the clearest signal yet that some part of the market is already hedging the outcome the equity index itself isn't pricing.

POLITICS

[NEW] The House passed a concurrent resolution in late July, 214-208, directing Trump under the War Powers Act to end hostilities

with Iran — the second such House vote of the war. Four Republicans crossed over: Tom Barrett (Mich.), Brian Fitzpatrick (Pa.), Warren Davidson (Ohio) and Thomas Massie (Ky.). A companion joint resolution failed in the Senate, 47-49. Neither is binding, and Trump would almost certainly veto anything that reached his desk, but the votes are the clearest signal yet of congressional discomfort with a war lawmakers never authorized — discomfort that predates and now frames Araghchi's Sunday conditions, and that will resurface if the Oman track stalls again.

[NEW] Kevin Warsh's path to the Fed chair is itself a political data point worth holding alongside the Lead's rate-odds numbers. Trump nominated him in January over a field of alternatives specifically for his inflation-hawk reputation; the Senate confirmed him 54-45 in May along near-total party lines, with only Sen. John Fetterman (D-Pa.) crossing over. Powell, whose term as chair expired in May, stayed on as a governor with two years left to serve — an unusual arrangement that puts a Trump-picked hawk and a Biden-era holdover on the same committee for the September meeting. That internal composition is part of why markets are still pricing meaningful hike odds into a week with a negative jobs print: Warsh was installed to resist exactly the kind of energy-driven inflation risk Monday's oil move represents, and traders are treating that mandate as credible.

ECONOMICS

[NEW] July's payrolls miss was the headline number, but the size of it is the story: -23,000 against a +80,000 consensus is not a soft beat, it's an outright contraction. That single print did more to move September rate-hike odds (67% to 44% on CME FedWatch) than any

Fed communication this cycle. Wednesday's July CPI and Thursday's PPI now carry outsized weight — both because they're the next hard data before the September 16 FOMC, and because Monday's crude rally reopens the question of energy pass-through just as Warsh's Fed is being tested on credibility.

[NEW] The consumer side of that equation is already showing up at the pump: AAA's national average gas price stood at \$4.0121 as of Sunday, a level that puts retail energy costs squarely in the CPI's transportation-fuel component investors will watch Wednesday. Friday's retail sales print and the University of Michigan's preliminary sentiment read will be the first real test of whether \$4-plus gas and a stalling labor market are showing up in consumer behavior yet, or whether the record equity tape is still doing enough to offset both. The Treasury's 13- and 26-week bill auctions clear today with no drama expected; the more consequential auction, the 30-year bond, doesn't land until August 17, giving the long end a full week to digest whatever CPI and PPI say about where Warsh's Fed leans next.

BUSINESS

[NEW] Alphabet raised \$25 billion in a 10-tranche, investment-grade bond sale (2- to 40-year maturities) that closed Thursday with roughly \$115 billion in peak demand — the third-largest order book of the year behind Oracle's February \$129 billion deal and Amazon's March \$126 billion. Proceeds fund AI infrastructure; Alphabet has now raised more than \$50 billion in debt in the first half of 2026 alone, on top of nearly \$85 billion in equity issuance earlier in the year, and has guided 2026 capex to as much as \$205 billion — more than double 2025's outlay. Amazon, Meta and Oracle collectively

have issued about \$194 billion in investment-grade bonds through July, up 79% year-over-year: the AI buildout is increasingly debt-financed, not just funded from operating cash flow, which raises the stakes of Wednesday's CPI for the credit market as much as for equities.

[NEW] Earnings reaction is bifurcating sharply on where AI spending shows up. Shopify rose 17% after reporting that AI integration tripled customer traffic and orders — a case where AI investment is visibly hitting the top line. AMD fell 7% despite beating estimates and guiding third-quarter revenue above consensus, as investors demanded more from a stock that had already rallied hard into the print. The pattern investors are drawing from both reports: the market is no longer rewarding AI capex or AI-linked revenue growth on its own, only evidence that it's converting into results ahead of expectations, not merely in line with them.

[NEW] The earnings calendar stays heavy all week — roughly 226 companies reported Monday, with counts of 174, 186 and 291 on Tuesday through Thursday before tapering to 51 on Friday, per Yahoo Finance's tracker — meaning Wednesday's CPI print lands in the middle of the year's densest reporting stretch rather than a quiet data week. Cisco and Applied Materials, both listed on the Board, are the two prints most likely to move sentiment on AI-infrastructure spending specifically, alongside whatever tone Wednesday and Thursday's inflation data set for how the market reads every subsequent report.

TECHNOLOGY

[NEW] AMD's underlying numbers were strong even as the stock sold off on Business's earnings-bar dynamic: Q2 revenue rose 50%

year-over-year to \$11.5 billion, with the data-center segment more than doubling on AI infrastructure demand; the company also acquired a chip startup that hardwires AI models directly into silicon. On memory — the component increasingly cited as the AI buildout's binding constraint — Samsung and SK Hynix both unveiled architecture aimed at the bottleneck: vertical-stacking "zHBM" and new high-bandwidth-flash (HBF) standards, with SK Hynix committing \$38 billion to two new plants. Astera Labs posted record Q2 revenue of \$392.4 million, up 104% year-over-year, on demand for its AI-connectivity Scorpio switches — a smaller name benefiting from the same infrastructure wave as the AMD and Alphabet items above.

[DEVELOPING] The broader read across all of Monday's tech items: AI capex is spilling past the traditional chipmaker cohort — Nvidia, AMD, TSMC, Samsung — into companies that have historically just bought chips rather than made them. Tesla and SpaceX are reportedly planning their own semiconductor facility in Texas, following a pattern already visible in the hyperscalers' shift from renting compute to owning more of the stack. For investors, the implication is that AI-linked capital intensity is no longer a story about four or five companies' balance sheets — it's showing up in bond issuance (Business), memory supply chains, and now vertical integration bets by companies outside the traditional semiconductor industry entirely.

GEOPOLITICS

[NEW] Yemen's Houthis claimed an attack Saturday on a Saudi Aramco refinery — a Red Sea-theater strike distinct from the Hormuz fighting itself, but part of the same widening conflict system Iran's proxies are running against Gulf energy infrastructure. It lands the same week Congress is publicly split on war powers (Politics, above), underscoring that the war's geographic footprint keeps expanding even as the Hormuz-specific negotiating track narrows toward a technical, partial fix. **Single-sourced to Houthi claims as of press time** — no independent confirmation of refinery damage located this run.

[NEW] Zooming out on the war itself: the conflict began February 28 with US and Israeli strikes on Iranian military and nuclear sites, after which Iran imposed its Hormuz blockade on March 4. A June 17 ceasefire memorandum between Trump and Iranian president Masoud Pezeshkian collapsed by July 8 when Iran resumed attacks on commercial shipping, restarting the cycle now in its fifth month. Cumulative reported tolls include 17 seafarers and 1 port worker killed, with roughly 20,000 mariners and 2,000 ships stranded in the Persian Gulf at the crisis's April peak — figures compiled from open reporting and not independently re-verified this run. Brent's brief spike above \$100 in March and peak near \$126 remain the high-water mark against which Monday's \$84.39 should be read: still elevated, but well off the war's worst pricing.

IRAN & HORMUZ

[DEVELOPING] Beyond the Lead's market mechanics: the Oman-Iran technical track has produced real, specific progress — agreed

inbound/outbound shipping-lane coordinates and a proposed joint coordination center to manage traffic and vessel information — after more than three weeks of talks Oman's foreign ministry called "positive and constructive." What it has not produced is Iranian sign-off on reopening, which Araghchi and the IRGC both tied Sunday and Saturday to a separate, harder list: an end to the US naval blockade, a US troop withdrawal, and financial compensation from Washington. The Board's transit counters above show the practical result — traffic ticking up off the crisis floor (84 weekly transits, versus a 45-vessel prior week) but nowhere close to the ~120-140 vessels a day that crossed before the war began.

[DEVELOPING] The stranded-vessel picture is the less-visible half of the story. During the June-July ceasefire, the number of mainstream tankers sitting in the Gulf fell from over 160 to 29 as ships took advantage of the lull to move; since the truce broke down, roughly 65 new vessels have entered the queue and remain stranded, on top of 70-plus that have sat there since the conflict began in February — a working population that has barely shrunk despite the reopening talk. Reconciling the Board's counters: PortWatch's AIS-based daily snapshot (2 ships on August 2) and Lloyd's List's weekly analyst rollup (84 transits that week) are not in conflict — they're counting different things over different windows, with Lloyd's figure explicitly including an estimated dark-fleet share that PortWatch's real-time feed can't yet see. Neither should be treated as more "correct"; they answer different questions.

[DEVELOPING] On the insurance side, Kpler's analysis of the war-risk market found that premiums rose rapidly on each attack but have declined only slowly, if at all, even through multi-week stretches without incidents — insurers are pricing tail risk, not

current conditions, and told clients rates would normalize only once sustained incident-free transit rebuilds actuarial confidence. That asymmetry is itself informative for the Fed and CPI questions in the Lead: even in the scenario where the Oman-Iran technical deal holds and transit volume keeps recovering, the shipping-cost and insurance component of landed oil prices is likely to stay elevated well past the point the strait itself reopens.

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Braves 5-4 (Sat., Aug. 8; Cole 7 IP). Now 64-51, 3rd AL East.
Knicks	Off-season. Reigning 2026 NBA champions (beat Spurs 4-1, clinched June 14). No game.
Northwestern	Off-season. 2026 opener Sept. 5 vs. South Dakota State at Martin Stadium.

Continuity. This is issue No. 1 — no prior daily-brief/latest.md existed to check against, so every item above is tagged [NEW] rather than compared against a prior day. Tomorrow's issue will begin dropping items that haven't moved.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory; where a number could not be confirmed this run, it is labeled as such rather than guessed.